Climate and environment had a very significant impact on the expansion of modern humans. [13] Our planet goes through natural cycles of cooling and heating. When early humans made their way out of Africa, the earth was much cooler and much of the world's water was locked in giant ice-sheets. As a result, sea-levels were as much as 100 metres lower than today and coastlines and climate zones would have been very different. Thus, the early band of humans migrating from Africa to southern Arabia would have had to make a relatively short crossing across the Red Sea. Furthermore, they would have found an Arabian coastline that was much wetter and more hospitable.

It appears that modern humans next made their way along the coast to what is now the Persian Gulf. The average depth of the Persian Gulf is merely 36 metres. [14] With sea-levels 100 metres below current levels, this area would have been a well-watered plain—a veritable Garden of Eden. The groups of early humans would have found this a very attractive location and probably enjoyed a significant population increase. Expansion into Central Asia and Europe would have been difficult at this stage because of the Ice Age. However, they would have spread out along the Makran coast into the Indian subcontinent. Note again, that the Indian coastline would have been different from what we see today and, in many places, the shore would have been 25–100 km out from current contours.

At some stage, branches of the Persian Gulf people pushed their way farther into the Indian subcontinent. The landscape being traversed by these early migrations *had* supported other hominid populations. [15] In Europe, we know that the Neanderthals steadily withdrew westwards till one of the last bands died out in a cave in Gibraltar. However, it is unclear what happened to the pre-modern hominids of Asia. The eruption of the Toba volcano in Sumatra 74,000 years ago may have played some role in their extinction as excavations in Jwalapuram show that peninsular India was covered in volcanic ash from the eruptions. Experts still disagree on the impact but it is possible that the eruption may have decimated the population of pre-modern hominids that lived in the subcontinent at that